

FOR CREATIVE STRATEGISTS

Your swipe folder will stay a folder of screenshots.

Until you run it through these four questions.



@csos

Swipe →

THE SITUATION

A newer creative strategist will often collect ads and never read them carefully, while the folder gets long and the writing stays the same.

Four questions is all it takes to turn that pile of screenshots into a body of thinking a prospect will pay to see.

Four questions is all it takes to turn that pile of screenshots into a body of thinking a prospect will pay to see.

QUESTION ONE

Who is the first line talking to?

Picture a specific person with an age, a life stage, and a mood they are in when the ad lands.

If you cannot picture them, the ad is not as sharp as it looks, and you are about to learn something about where it will break.

Who is the first line talking to?

QUESTION TWO

What does it promise them in the first three seconds?

Write the promise in one sentence that does not mention the product by name.

If the promise cannot fit in one sentence, the ad is losing a share of its audience right there in the opening.

What does it promise them in the first three seconds?

QUESTION THREE

How does the ad make that promise believable?

A face on camera, a before and after, a stat, a mechanism, or a customer quote counted in one named move.

Naming one move a week will sharpen your own writing faster than any course you could buy.

How does the ad make that promise believable?

QUESTION FOUR

What would you test next if this account was yours?

One specific change, and your hypothesis on what would happen to the result.

This is the answer a creative strategist is paid to produce for a living, so practice it before anyone is paying you for it.

What would you test next if this account was yours?

THE HABIT

One ad, one page, once a week, with the four questions written out in full sentences on the page.

By the end of month three, you have a body of thinking that doubles as proof of thinking for every prospect you speak to.

By the end of month three, you have a body of thinking that doubles as proof of thinking for every prospect you speak to.

NEXT STEP

Ready to test your creative strategy skills?

Take the 3-minute creative strategy quiz.

→ adscreativestrategy.com/quiz